After Hours — MVP Product Requirements Document

Version: 1.0 (draft for engineering review) **Date:** September 2026 **Owner:** Product **Source inputs:** After Hours Leadership Review deck (Aug 2026); After Hours MVP Estimation sheet (132 mobile hrs / 118 backend hrs / 24 QA / 16 UX = 274 hrs)

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1. Purpose and framing

India already pays to attend singles events — ₹99–1,799 a ticket, sold through Instagram DMs and generic ticketing platforms that verify nobody. After Hours is the platform underneath those operators: it verifies the people, holds the gender ratio, sells the seat, checks people in, and only then lets attendees match with each other.

The MVP exists to answer four questions the leadership deck flagged as unknown. Everything in scope should serve at least one:

Question	What the MVP must produce
Will clubs/hosts list on a platform they don't own?	Self-serve host onboarding with zero manual hand-holding
Will members pay for a verified seat?	Paid, UPI-completed bookings — not RSVPs
Does the ratio actually hold?	System-enforced gating, with measured pre-door and at-door ratios
Do members come back?	Post-event matching that drives a second booking

Explicit non-goal: this is not a swiping app with events attached. Discovery of people happens *after* a shared room, never before.

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2. MVP scope

Three surfaces on one shared backend.

Surface	Platform	In MVP
End-User App	Cross-platform mobile (RN/Flutter), iOS + Android	Yes
Host App	Separate cross-platform mobile app	Yes
Admin Dashboard	Web only	Yes — see §7, currently unestimated

2.1 In scope

- Member signup, OTP, selfie/ID verification, event browse, booking + UPI payment, QR ticket

- Ratio gating at the point of ticket release
- Host signup, license/document verification, event creation and publishing, QR check-in, attendee list, payout data
- Post-event swipe among checked-in attendees only; text chat on mutual match
- Push notifications, cloud infra, CI/CD

2.2 Out of scope for MVP (deck features deliberately deferred)

Venue F&B rebate tracking · the venue-to-club room marketplace (a venue offering its floor to a third-party club, rather than running its own night) · membership subscription tier (₹399–999) · brand sponsorship · trips and getaways · niche/invite-only rooms (single parents, next chapter, elderly) · club-affiliation and "who's going next" social graph · media/voice in chat.

Revenue in MVP is the **20% host marketplace fee on ticket value only**. The 15% venue rebate is a manual, off-platform commercial agreement during the pilot.

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3. Users and core objects

Member — a verified single buying a seat. **Host** — a club, community, venue or founder-operator publishing and running a night. **Decided:** venues onboard as Hosts in MVP. There is one Host App, one onboarding flow and one verification pipeline; `host_type` (club / community / venue / individual operator) is a profile attribute that varies the required documents and the default event template, not a separate surface.

A venue Host in MVP is a venue running *its own* night on its own floor — the "fill a quiet Tuesday, no marketing spend" case from the deck. A venue renting its floor to a third-party club is a two-sided transaction between two Host accounts and is out of MVP; during the pilot that pairing is brokered by ops, and the club is the Host of record on the listing. **Admin** — After Hours ops, reviewing verifications and resolving disputes.

Core objects: `User`, `HostAccount`, `Event`, `TicketType`, `Booking`, `CheckIn`, `MatchSelection`, `Match`, `ChatThread`, `Payout`.

The central rule of the system: `CheckIn` is the gate. No scanned QR at the venue, no entry into the event's matching pool. This applies with no exceptions and no manual admin override in MVP.

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4. End-User App requirements

4.1 Registration

(Est. 8 mobile / 12 backend)

- Phone-number signup with OTP; session tokens with refresh, secure device storage.

- Minimum profile: first name, date of birth, gender, city, one photo.
- Hard age gate at 18+, derived from DOB, non-editable after verification.
- Gender is collected at signup because the ratio engine depends on it. It is set once; changes require admin action.
- DPDP Act 2023: explicit consent capture at signup, versioned and timestamped, covering identity verification, photo storage and sharing of first-name-and-photo with co-attendees post-event.

Acceptance: a user can go from install to a complete unverified profile in under 90 seconds.

4.2 Selfie / ID verification

(Est. 12 mobile / 4 backend — third-party vendor, integration effort only)

- Guided liveness selfie capture plus government ID capture, submitted to the vendor SDK/API.
- States: `unverified` → `pending` → `verified` | `rejected`. Client polls or receives push on state change.
- On rejection: reason shown, one retry permitted, then admin queue.
- **Verification is mandatory before checkout.** Browsing is open to unverified users; paying is not. This is the single strongest differentiator versus District/AllEvents and must not be softened for conversion.
- Raw ID images are not retained past the vendor's verification result; store only the pass/fail, vendor reference ID, and a derived age. Confirm retention window with legal before build.

Acceptance: median verification decision returns in under 3 minutes; a verified user is never asked to verify again.

4.3 Event browsing and filtering

(Est. 6 mobile / 6 backend)

- List and grid views of upcoming events in the user's city, sorted by date.
- Filters: date range, price band, neighbourhood, format (dinner, tasting, pottery, board games, etc.), host.
- Text search across event title and host name.
- Event detail page: host name and verification badge, venue area (exact address released only after booking), date/time, format, price, seats remaining *for the user's gender*, ratio policy statement, cancellation terms.
- Sold-out-for-your-gender state must be distinct from sold-out-entirely, and should offer a waitlist join.

Acceptance: a user in Indiranagar can find and open a relevant event in under three taps from home.

4.4 Booking, ratio gating and payment

(Est. 16 mobile / 12 backend, plus 8/8 for gateway/SDK setup)

Ratio gating is the load-bearing feature here. Requirements:

- Each event defines a target ratio of **50:50 with a ±10 percentage-point tolerance band** — i.e. no gender may exceed 60% of sold seats, and the room is considered in-policy anywhere between 60:40 and 40:60. Hosts may tighten the band but not widen it.
- The band is enforced **continuously against seats sold so far**, not checked at the end. A gender is blocked from purchase the moment the next sale would push it past 60% of *current* sold inventory; it unblocks automatically as the other side fills. This is what makes the band a gate rather than a report.
- Guard against the small-numbers problem: the band is not enforced below a floor of 10 sold seats, otherwise the 3rd ticket of the night blocks a sale on a meaningless percentage.
- **Directional asymmetry — decided.** The band is enforced asymmetrically, because a room tipping female is a tolerable outcome while a room tipping male is the failure mode the product exists to prevent:
  - **Male ceiling: hard.** At 60% male of sold seats, male purchase is blocked outright. Waitlist offered.
  - **Female ceiling: soft.** Past 60% female, purchase continues to succeed. The system surfaces a non-blocking warning to the host on the dashboard and to After Hours ops, and the event is tagged as skewed for pilot reporting. No member-facing message — a woman should never be told the room has too many women in it.
- **Consequence of the soft ceiling:** the room's *effective* male allocation grows as women buy, so male inventory must be recomputed against live sold volume rather than fixed at publish time. A soft-capped female side and a hard-capped male side is what makes recomputation, not static pools, mandatory in the build. Male seats freed by late female sales should trigger a waitlist release.
- Because the female side is uncapped, capacity is the binding limit on that side: female sales stop only at total event capacity. Hosts must be able to see, at a glance, how many male seats remain *unlockable* versus outright sold out.
- Tickets are released against the resulting gender caps, not the total. When the male side is blocked, show an honest message ("this room is holding its ratio — join the waitlist and we'll release seats as it balances") and a waitlist option. In practice the waitlist is a male-side mechanism.
- Hosts may configure a **release schedule** — e.g. hold back a share of male inventory until the female pool crosses a threshold — supporting the women-first seeding strategy in the deck.
- Inventory decrements must be transactional and race-safe. Overselling a gender pool breaks the core promise; treat a seat as held for a bounded window (10 min) during checkout and released on failure or timeout.

- Ratio state must be observable to the host in real time and logged for pilot measurement (pre-door ratio, at-door ratio, and their delta).

Payment: - UPI via the licensed gateway partner; intent and collect flows. Card as secondary if the gateway supports it at no extra build cost. - Booking is confirmed only on gateway success webhook, never on client-side success callback. - Idempotent order creation; reconciliation job for pending/ambiguous transactions. - On confirmation: QR ticket issued (signed, single-use, tied to booking + user), stored offline-capable in the app, plus push and receipt.

Cancellation and refunds (gap — not in the estimate, see §7): MVP needs at minimum a host-initiated event cancellation with full auto-refund, and a stated no-user-refund policy inside a cutoff window. Without this the pilot cannot legally run.

Acceptance: zero oversold gender pools across the pilot; payment-to-ticket latency under 10 seconds at p95.

4.5 Post-event matching ("the morning after")

(Est. 16 mobile / 12 backend)

- The matching pool for an event opens at 09:00 the morning after the event ends and stays open for **72 hours**, closing at 09:00 on the third day. Configurable per environment, not per event.
- Both parties see a countdown on the pool, with a reminder push at 24 hours remaining. A user who has not opened the pool at all gets a second reminder at 12 hours.
- **Late-match consequence:** a match made in the pool's final hour still gets its full 72-hour chat window, so a single event's social tail can run up to six days from the night itself. The next event's pool may open before the last one's chats have closed. The match list must therefore show which event each match came from, and analytics must attribute matches and messages to the originating event rather than to a calendar week.
- **Eligibility is strictly `CheckIn` records for that event.** A user who bought a ticket and did not scan in appears to nobody and sees nobody.
- Card view showing first name, age, photo, and a one-line prompt answer. No last names, no contact details, no cross-event history, no location.
- Left/right swipe with a per-event cap on right-swipes (default: 5) to keep selection deliberate rather than exhaustive.
- Mutual right-swipe creates a `Match`. Non-mutual selections are never surfaced — counts only, never names, per the deck's safety commitment.
- Opt-in per event: a member may decline to appear in a given event's pool at check-in or any time before the pool opens.

Acceptance: no user can view any other user's card without both parties holding a check-in record for the same event.

4.6 Chat on match

(Est. 16 mobile / 16 backend)

- Text-only, realtime over websockets, with a match list and unread indicators.
- Chat opens on mutual match and remains open for **72 hours from match creation** (configurable per environment, not per user). The window is deliberately long enough to survive a working week's schedule — a match made Sunday morning is still live Tuesday night — while still forcing the conversation to go somewhere.
- The window is shown to both parties as a visible countdown from the moment the thread opens. Users must never discover the expiry by losing a conversation.
- At expiry the thread closes to new messages. **Decision needed on history:** either the transcript stays readable in a closed state, or it is removed entirely. Recommend keeping it readable and removing the ability to send, so expiry does not read as data loss.
- Warning push at 12 hours remaining, and again at 1 hour, to each party.
- The paid tier's chat extension now sells time *beyond* 72 hours. That is a weaker proposition than extending beyond 24, and should be revisited when the tier is specced — the extension is out of MVP scope regardless.
- Required in-chat controls: **block**, **report**, and unmatch. Block is silent to the blocked party and removes both users from each other's future event pools.
- Message retention and deletion behaviour must be defined against DPDP before build.

Acceptance: message delivery under 1s at p95; block takes effect immediately and irreversibly for that pair.

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5. Host App requirements

5.1 Registration and license verification

(Est. 8/6 and 10/10)

- Host signup with business/organiser name, contact, city, and `host_type` (club, community, venue, individual operator). `host_type` is selected at signup and drives the rest of the flow.
- **Document requirements are conditional on `host_type`.** Venues carry a materially heavier set than clubs, and this is the main build delta from the venue decision:

`host_type`	Required at onboarding
Club / community / individual operator	Business registration or organiser identity document; PAN; bank/UPI payout details
Venue	The above, plus premises address proof, FSSAI registration where food is served, and — where alcohol is served — the applicable

`host_type`	Required at onboarding
	state excise licence with its validity dates

- Excise and FSSAI licences have **expiry dates that must be stored and enforced**. A venue Host with a lapsed licence cannot publish a new event and its future published events are flagged to admin. Expiry warnings at 30 and 7 days.
- Excise rules are state-level, so the required document set must be configurable per city rather than hardcoded. Bangalore is the only configuration needed for the pilot.
- Manual admin review workflow with status tracking and push/email notifications on decision.
- A host cannot publish a public event until verified. Draft creation is permitted while pending, so onboarding doesn't stall on review latency.
- Bank/UPI payout details captured at onboarding with penny-drop or gateway-side validation.

5.2 Event creation and publishing

(Est. 12 mobile / 8 backend)

- Event form: title, description, format, date/time, venue and address, capacity, ratio target and release schedule, ticket price(s), cancellation terms, cover media upload.
- Draft → submit → published lifecycle. First three events per host route through admin approval; after that, auto-publish with post-hoc review.
- Edit rules: price and date are locked once the first ticket sells; capacity may increase but not fall below tickets sold.

5.3 Running the night — dashboard, check-in, payouts

(Est. 16 mobile / 12 backend)

- Dashboard: tickets sold by gender against target, revenue to date, live ratio, male seats remaining vs. currently locked, countdown to doors. A non-blocking skew warning appears once the room passes 60% female.
- **QR check-in scanner** with camera scan, immediate valid/invalid/already-used feedback, and manual name-search fallback. Must work offline with a local queue and sync on reconnect — venue wifi is not a dependency the door can afford.
- Attendee list with check-in status and no-show flags.
- Payout view: gross ticket value, 20% platform fee, net payable, status (pending / processing / paid). MVP payouts are executed via the gateway with an ops-triggered batch, T+2 after the event.
- Venue Hosts see the same ticket payout view. Their F&B rebate does **not** appear here — it is settled off-platform during the pilot (§2.2), and the dashboard should not imply otherwise.

Acceptance: a host can check in 64 attendees in under 12 minutes with one scanner device.

6. Foundation and platform

(Est. 0/8 infra + 4/4 notifications)

- Single shared backend service layer for all three surfaces. Role-based access; host and member identities are separate accounts.
- Cloud infra, environments (dev/staging/prod), CI/CD pipelines, automated builds for both apps.
- Push via FCM/APNs. MVP notification set: verification decision, booking confirmation, event reminder (24h and 2h), matching pool open, new match, new message, host verification and event approval decisions.
- Audit logging for every verification decision, ratio-gate block, check-in, and payout — the pilot's gates depend on this data being trustworthy.

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7. Gaps between this PRD and the estimate

These are required for a live pilot but carry **no hours** in the current estimation sheet. Each needs a decision before sprint planning:

Gap	Why it matters	Suggested call
Admin web dashboard	Assumptions name it; no line item exists. Manual verification review, host approval, refunds and incident handling all land here	Estimate separately — likely 40–60 backend/web hours
Refunds and cancellations	Cannot legally sell tickets without it	Add to MVP
Report / block / safety escalation and "discreet in-app help signal"	Promised explicitly in the deck's trust section	Add block+report to MVP; defer the help signal to fast-follow
DPDP consent, data export and deletion	Legal review is listed as a pre-build gate	Add to MVP
Analytics instrumentation	The 90-day plan is gated on measured funnel, ratio and repeat data. Untracked pilots prove nothing	Add to MVP
Waitlist mechanics	Implied by gender-pool sell-outs and women-first seeding	Add to MVP
Licence expiry tracking (excise/FSSAI) and per-city document config	Follows directly from onboarding venues as Hosts; the estimate's "license verification" line assumes a	Add to MVP — small, but it is a legal exposure if skipped

Gap	Why it matters	Suggested call
	single flat document set	
Host payout reconciliation ops tooling	APIs are estimated, the ops surface is not	Manual/spreadsheet for pilot is acceptable

The 274-hour figure should be read as the build cost of the happy path, not of a launchable pilot.

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8. Success metrics for the 90-day Bangalore pilot

Mapped to the deck's four gates.

Gate	Metric	Target
Weeks 1–2	Qualified waitlist leads	500
Weeks 3–4	Paid attendance across 2 events	≥80% of capacity sold, ≥85% of sold tickets checked in
Weeks 5–8	At-door gender ratio across 6 events	**No room above 60% male** (hard gate). Female skew above 60% tracked, not failed
Weeks 9–12	Repeat purchase	≥25% of attendees book a second event

Supporting metrics: verification completion rate, verification-to-checkout drop-off, match rate per event, chat-initiation rate on match, host self-serve completion without ops intervention.

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9. Open questions for leadership

1. Is verification-before-payment non-negotiable, given it will visibly depress first-event conversion?
2. ~~Default ratio target~~ and ~~female-side ceiling~~ — **Resolved:** 50:50 with a ±10pt band, enforced asymmetrically — hard male ceiling, soft female ceiling with a host-facing warning only.
3. ~~Chat window length~~ and ~~matching-pool window~~ — **Resolved: 72 hours each.** Follow-ons: (a) does an expired thread stay readable or disappear? (b) what does the paid extension sell now that the free window is 3 days?
4. ~~Venue onboarding~~ — **Resolved:** venues onboard as Hosts in MVP, one shared surface with `host_type`-conditional documents. Follow-on: the excise/FSSAI expiry tracking this requires is not in the current estimate (§7), and the venue-to-club room marketplace stays ops-brokered.

5. Thursday's India trading status — still unresolved, and it changes the competitive framing of the Host App.